Bánh mì

Toasted baguette with pâté, pork and quick-pickled carrot and daikon

Serves 2 · **Prep** 20 min · **Cook** 10 min · **Rest** 30 min

> *Draft quantities for David to check. The vault note names the ingredients and steps but no amounts, so the quantities and timings are worked out and haven't been tested.*

The quick pickle is what makes it: crisp, sweet and sour against the rich pâté and pork. Make it first so it has half an hour to work.

INGREDIENTS

For the pickle

- 1 carrot, cut into matchsticks
- 150 g daikon, cut into matchsticks
- 125 ml (½ cup) rice vinegar
- 125 ml (½ cup) warm water
- 2 tbsp sugar
- ½ tsp salt

For the pork

- 250 g pork shoulder or loin, thinly sliced, or 200 g firm tofu, sliced
- 1 tbsp fish sauce (soy sauce for tofu)
- 1 tsp sugar
- 1 tbsp neutral oil

For the sandwiches

- 1 crisp baguette, cut into two lengths
- 2 tbsp mayonnaise
- 60 g pâté
- ½ cucumber, sliced lengthways
- A handful of coriander sprigs, with stalks

METHOD

1. **Pickle the vegetables.** Stir the vinegar, water, sugar and salt until dissolved. Add the carrot and daikon and leave for at least 30 minutes.
2. **Cook the pork.** Toss the pork with the fish sauce and sugar. Fry it in the oil over high heat for 2–3 minutes a side, until browned and cooked through.
3. **Toast the bread.** Split each length of baguette along one side and warm it in a hot oven for 3–4 minutes, until the crust crackles.
4. **Spread.** Spread mayonnaise on one cut side and pâté on the other.
5. **Fill.** Lay in the warm pork, the cucumber, a generous heap of drained pickles and the coriander. Eat straight away.

NOTES

- The pickle keeps for about a week in the fridge in its liquid.
- A sliced chilli and a few drops of Maggi seasoning are common extras.